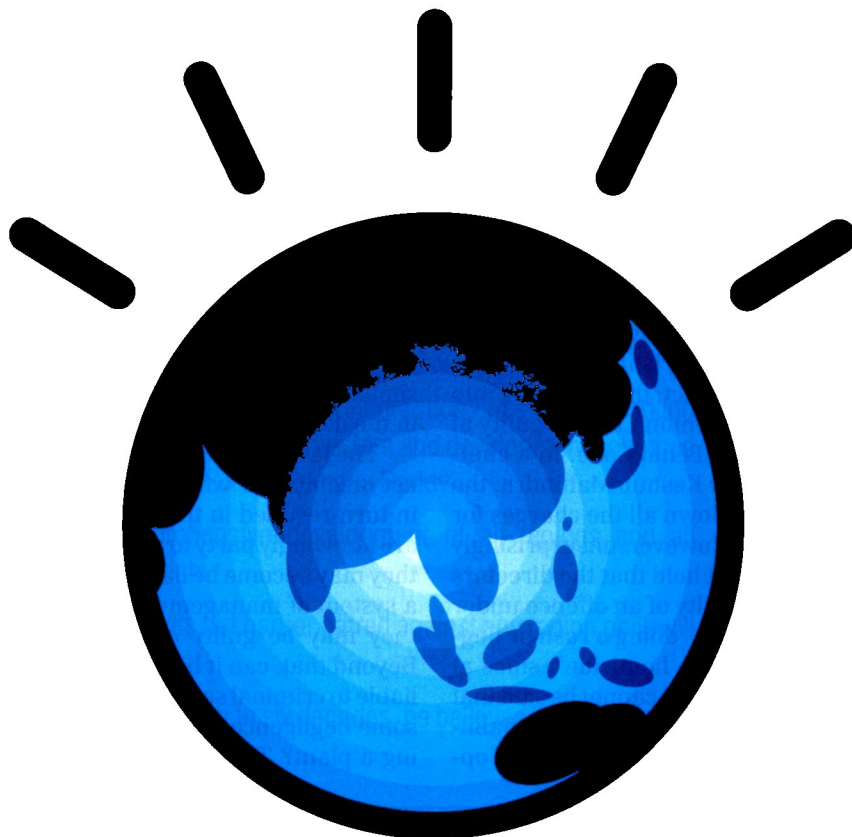




Welcome to the decade of smart.

A year ago, we began a conversation about how our planet can become smarter. A year into this new era, the signs of a smarter planet are all around us. Smarter systems are creating value in every major industry across the world.

Intelligence is being infused into systems and processes that make the world work — cars, appliances, traffic systems, power grids, even natural systems such as agriculture and waterways.

Trillions of digital devices, connected through the internet, are producing an ocean of data. And that information can now be turned into knowledge because we have the computational power and advanced analytics to make sense of it all.

In a study of 439 cities, those with transportation congestion systems reduced average travel delays by more than 700,000 hours annually. Leading retailers reduced supply chain costs by up to 30% and increased sales by up to 10%.

It's happening in India as well. Grameen Koota, a micro-finance organisation, employed a real-time data

transmission system that drastically reduced loan approval processing time and increased their served customer base of 70,000 to over 400,000 in less than three years. Indian Railways implemented an automated Crew Management System to manage its workforce of over 100,000 employees, resulting in new efficiencies in daily operations.

We've learned a lot over the past year about what it takes to build a smarter planet. We've also learned about the issues it raises in India and elsewhere — like protecting personal information and securing critical infrastructures.

Business leaders, policymakers and government officials around the world are currently stepping up to these challenges. The time to act is now, and the way to act is together. The decade of smart is under way.

Let's build a smarter planet. Join us and see what others are doing at ibm.com/smarterplanet/in

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